

Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends

2024 Stack Overflow Survey

Key findings on employment patterns, salary by role and language, and workplace preferences.

65,437

respondents

180+

countries

2024

survey year

Audience: engineering managers and HR leaders

Source: survey.stackoverflow.co/2024/work

84% of Developers Are Working, but Full-Time Employment Dips in the U.S.

Employment status benchmarks from 65,437 respondents

Global employment status



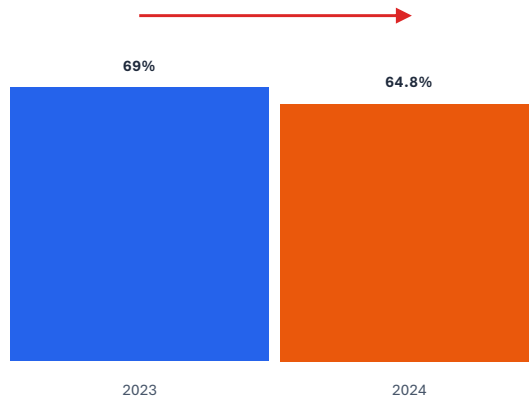
Full-time: 69%

Freelance: 16.4%

Student: 13.2%

84% are currently working full-time, part-time, or freelancing.

U.S. full-time employment

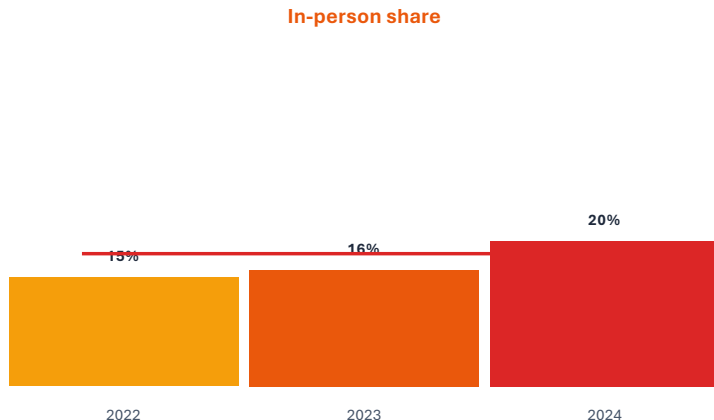


Contracting remains significant at 16%+
Germany and India skew more student-heavy
U.K. and Ukraine skew more contracting-heavy

In-Person Work Rises to 20% While Hybrid Holds Steady at 42%

Work environment trend signals gradual return-to-office momentum

Three-year work-environment trend



2024 arrangement mix

42%

hybrid

38%

remote

20%

in-person

Hybrid remains the dominant arrangement.

Senior Executives and Dev Advocates Top \$124K+ Median Salary

Median annual compensation by developer type, USD; 22,677 salary responses

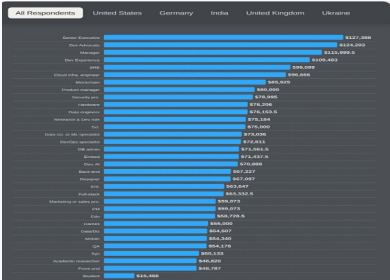
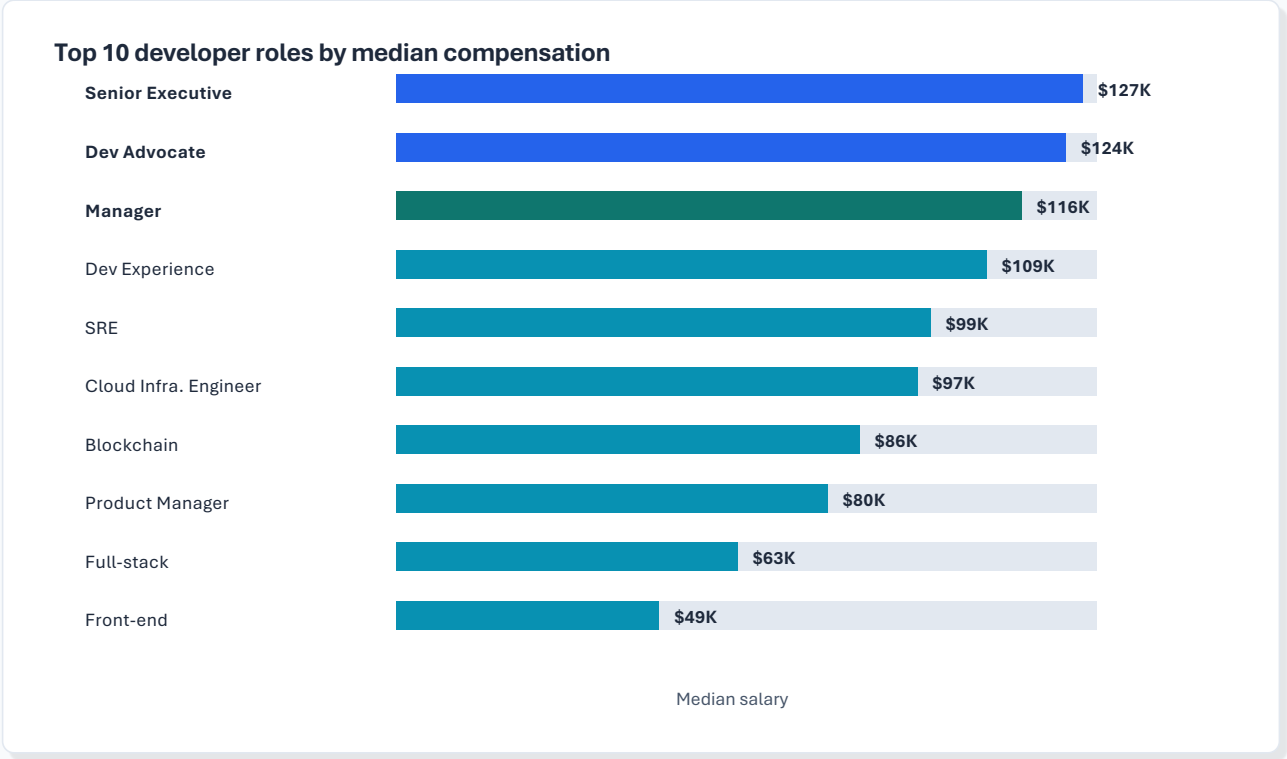


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Compensation readout

Leadership and DevRel roles command premium pay
SRE and cloud infrastructure are the top purely technical roles
Front-end median is \$48.8K in the provided benchmark set

Experience Pays: Top Roles Combine 14+ Years with Six-Figure Salaries

Median salary vs. average years of experience by developer type

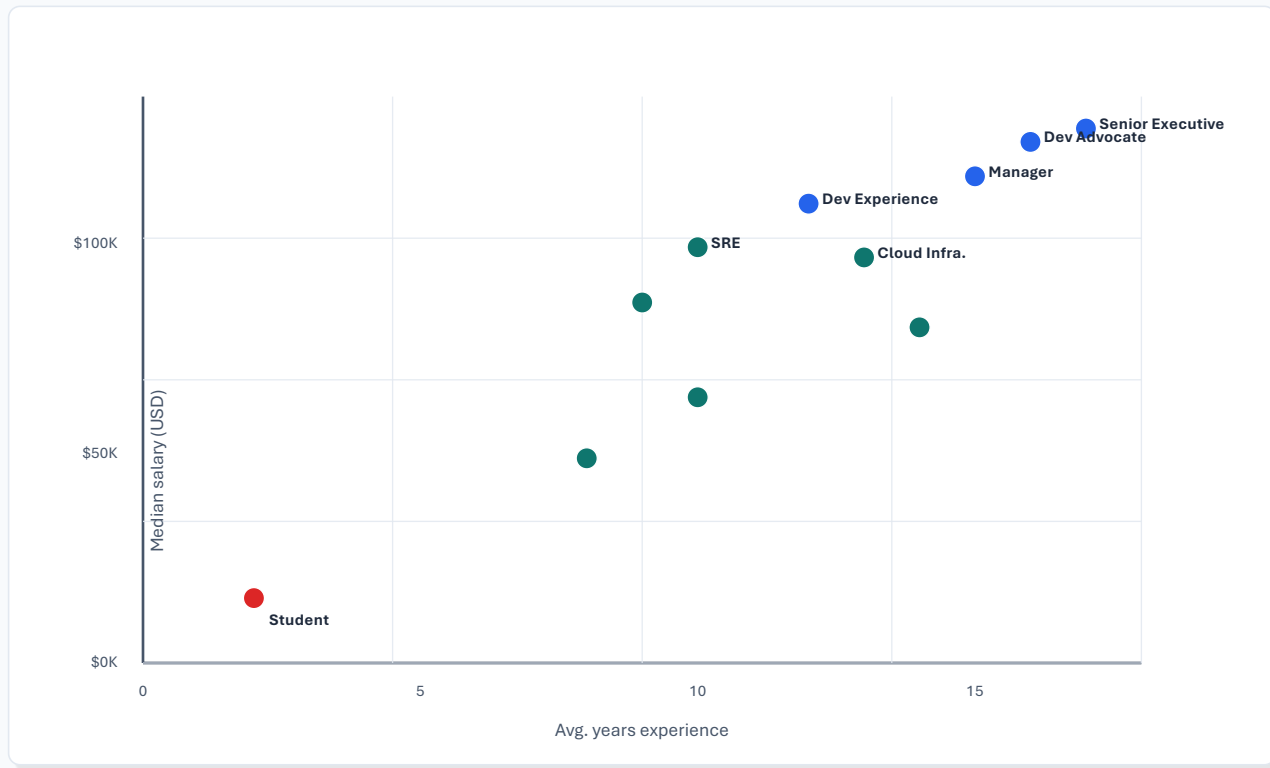


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Upper-right cluster

Senior Executive:
~\$127K at ~17 years
Dev Advocate: ~\$124K
at ~16 years
Manager: ~\$116K at ~15
years
Student outlier: ~\$15K
at ~2 years

Erlang & Clojure Developers Earn >\$95K; Dart & Prolog Below \$45K

Median salary vs. average years of experience by programming language

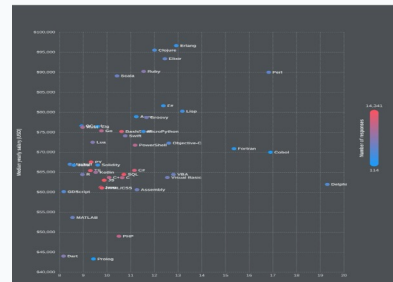


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Language signal

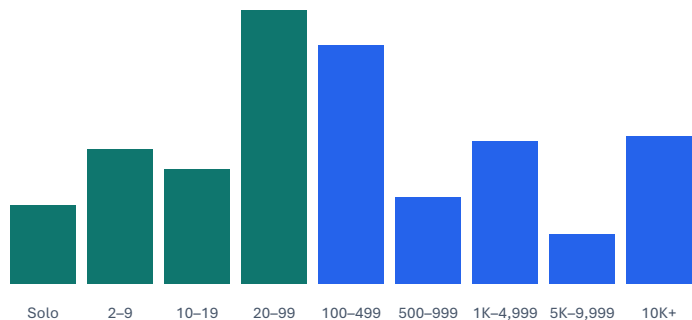
Niche functional languages lead: Erlang ~\$97K, Clojure ~\$95K, Elixir ~\$93K
Reported salary range dropped roughly \$10K vs. 2023
Dart and Prolog sit below \$45K

47% Work at Sub-100 Orgs; 62% Influence Tech Purchases

Company-size context and technology buying influence

Company-size distribution

Distribution across 42,827 respondents



47% work for organizations with fewer than 100 employees.

Purchasing influence

62%

influence purchases

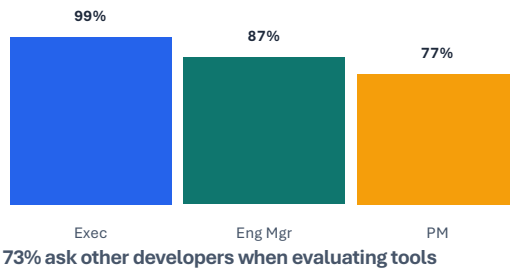
60%

prefer build-and-buy

75%

free trial

Most influential roles



73% ask other developers when evaluating tools

Takeaways: What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention

Benchmarks to inform compensation planning, workforce mix, and developer engagement.

01

Plan for a mixed workforce

Full-time employment is softening; contracting remains significant at 16%+.

02

Protect hybrid as the default

In-person work is rising, but hybrid remains the most common arrangement at 42%.

03

Budget premiums deliberately

DevRel, SRE, and cloud infrastructure roles command the highest compensation signals.

04

Use language mix as a pay signal

Niche functional-language ecosystems correlate with higher median salaries.

05

Engage developers in buying

62% influence tech purchases; free trials and peer input shape evaluation.